

Mindful Breathing & Body Scan

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Mindful breathing and the body scan build present-moment awareness and down-regulate the stress response. There is no 'right' feeling — the practice is simply noticing and gently returning attention.

Mindful breathing (5 minutes)

- Sit comfortably, eyes soft or closed. Let the breath be natural — don't force it.
- Notice where you feel the breath most clearly (nostrils, chest, or belly).
- Silently count: in for 4, out for 6. When the mind wanders, label 'thinking' and return.

Tension BEFORE breathing (0 = relaxed, 10 = very tense):



Tension AFTER breathing:



Body scan (10 minutes)

Slowly move attention through the body, pausing at each area. Notice sensations — warmth, tension, tingling, neutrality — with curiosity, not judgment. Breathe into areas of tightness and let them soften.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Feet & legs | ☐ Hips & lower back |
| ☐ Belly & chest | ☐ Hands & arms |
| ☐ Shoulders & neck | ☐ Face & head |

Where did I notice the most tension or sensation?

What did I notice about my mind wandering, and how did I respond?
